

IT Support Handbook

A fictional employee guide designed for testing document parsing, chunking, semantic retrieval, and source-grounded answers.

DOCUMENT DETAILS	VALUE
Document ID	NA-IT-2026-01
Edition	1.0 26 September 2026
Audience	Northstar Atlas employees and the IT service desk
Classification	Demo content - no real accounts, credentials, or live URLs

Inside this handbook

- 02 Account activation and password recovery
- 03 Multi-factor authentication and recovery
- 04 VPN access and remote connection
- 05 VPN troubleshooting and connection failures
- 06 Devices, security incidents, and data handling
- 07 Help desk tickets, priority, and escalation

HOW TO USE THIS DOCUMENT

All company names, URLs, contacts, time limits, and service commitments here are invented for the demo. The agent should answer only with evidence from these pages and say when a requested fact is absent.

Account activation and password recovery

The account owner and the requesting manager have separate responsibilities. IT does not provision new access from an informal chat message.

First-day activation

A hiring manager opens an onboarding request in the Northstar Atlas Help Desk at least three business days before the employee start date. The request includes the employee name, start date, team, manager, and required applications. IT creates the company account after the manager approves the request. A welcome message is sent to the employee's personal contact address recorded by People Operations.

- 01 Open the one-time activation link in the welcome message within 48 hours. The link expires after that window.
- 02 Set a new password, then register at least one multi-factor authentication method before signing in to company services.
- 03 Sign in to the Help Desk with the company account and confirm that the applications listed in the onboarding request are visible.

Forgotten password

From a device you trust, open help.northstar.example/reset and choose Reset password. Confirm your identity with a registered MFA method, then follow the recovery link. That link is valid for 15 minutes and can be used once. After setting a new password, sign out of old sessions and sign in again.

Locked account or unavailable recovery method

Five incorrect sign-in attempts within ten minutes temporarily lock the account for 20 minutes. Do not keep retrying during the lock. If no registered recovery method is available, open a Help Desk ticket from another device or call the service desk. IT verifies identity before starting manual recovery; managers cannot bypass that check.

SCOPE

Password reset instructions apply to the company account. This handbook does not describe payroll or personal banking password recovery.

Multi-factor authentication

MFA is required for the company account, VPN, and the Help Desk. An approval request should be accepted only when the employee initiated the sign-in.

Supported methods

The preferred method is the Northstar Authenticator mobile app. A FIDO2 security key is permitted as a backup. SMS is not an approved method for company account sign-in. Employees should register a second method before changing phones so that recovery does not depend on a single device.

01 To add a method, sign in to identity.northstar.example/security and open Security methods.

02 Select Add method, follow the enrollment steps, and complete a test sign-in.

03 If replacing a phone, verify the new method works before removing the old device.

Lost or replaced phone

If a registered FIDO2 key is available, use it to sign in and register the replacement phone. Otherwise, contact the Help Desk by phone and request MFA recovery. IT asks for the employee ID and verifies identity through the approved callback process. A manager's approval alone is not sufficient to reset MFA. The service desk does not ask for a password or an MFA approval code.

Unexpected approval prompts

Deny an MFA prompt you did not initiate. Within 15 minutes, report the prompt using the Security incident ticket category or the service desk phone line. Include the approximate time and the account shown on the prompt. Do not share screenshots that expose backup codes.

DO NOT APPROVE BLINDLY

If prompts continue after denial, change the company password from a trusted device and contact IT. An unsolicited prompt is not proof that the account has been compromised, but it requires review.

VPN access and remote connection

Remote access is available to approved employees using managed devices. VPN access is a separate permission from having a company account.

Requesting access

Submit the VPN access form in the Northstar Atlas Help Desk. Enter the business reason, expected end date, and the applications needed remotely. The employee's manager approves the business need; IT then assigns the VPN permission. A request without an end date is returned for clarification. Standard requests are reviewed within two business days after manager approval.

Setting up the VPN client

On a managed laptop, install Northstar Connect from the company software catalog. Choose the Corporate profile, sign in with the company account, and approve the MFA request you initiated. A successful connection shows Connected - Corporate in the client. Personal devices are not supported for VPN access.

- 01 Confirm the laptop has an internet connection before opening the VPN client.
- 02 Check that the client is updated through the company software catalog.
- 03 Connect with the Corporate profile and complete MFA; then open the internal application.

Inactive access

VPN permission is suspended after 30 consecutive days without a successful connection. To restore it, submit a new VPN access form; the manager must approve it again. Changing the device does not extend the inactivity window.

ACCESS BOUNDARY

The VPN does not grant access to every internal application. Application access is approved separately by the application owner. If a connection succeeds but one application denies access, request that application permission rather than reinstalling the VPN client.

VPN troubleshooting

Use the exact client message and the last successful connection time when opening a ticket. The following checks do not require administrator access.

Symptom	First Check	Next Action
Authentication failed	Confirm the laptop clock is set automatically, then retry sign-in and MFA once.	If the account itself is locked, use the recovery process on page 2.
Connection timed out	Test a normal website without VPN and try another trusted network.	If internet works, restart Northstar Connect and record the time of failure.
Connected but app denied	Verify the client says Connected - Corporate.	Request the missing application permission from its owner.
MFA prompt did not arrive	Check the phone network and open the authenticator app.	Use a registered FIDO2 key or follow MFA recovery on page 3.

Information to include in a VPN ticket

Provide the client error message, laptop asset tag, approximate time and time zone, network type (home, office, or mobile), and the name of the affected application. Never attach a password, MFA code, recovery code, or complete authentication log containing secrets.

When to stop troubleshooting

After the first checks above, open a Help Desk ticket under Remote access. If many employees lose access at the same time, call the service desk and mention a possible shared outage. Do not repeatedly approve unexpected MFA prompts in an attempt to reconnect.

CONNECTION VERSUS AUTHORIZATION

A working VPN connection and permission to an application are different states. Treat them as separate checks in troubleshooting and in a support answer.

Devices, incidents, and data handling

Managed devices receive updates centrally. Employees must report a lost device quickly even if it appears to be locked or encrypted.

Routine care

Leave managed laptops connected to power on Tuesdays at 20:00 Korea Standard Time for the weekly update window. Restart when prompted within 24 hours. IT may defer a restart during a scheduled customer presentation if a ticket is opened before the update window. The software catalog is the approved source for workplace applications; administrator access is not given to install unapproved software.

Lost device or suspected theft

Call the service desk and open a Security incident ticket within one hour of discovery. Include the asset tag if known, last known location, and approximate time last seen. IT can begin a remote lock and review access sessions. Do not wait for a police report before notifying IT. If the device later appears, do not reconnect it until IT clears it.

Sensitive information

Company documents labeled Restricted may be stored only in approved company storage. Do not copy them to a personal email account or public file-sharing link. When reporting an incident, describe the type of data involved without attaching the sensitive files themselves. The service desk will route the case to the security team.

Suspected phishing

Use the Report suspicious message button in company mail. If a link was clicked or credentials were entered, also open a Security incident ticket immediately and state exactly what action occurred. Do not delete the message before reporting it; the security team may need its headers.

EXAMPLE CLASSIFICATION

This handbook is synthetic demo content. Its rules are fictional, but the parser and assistant should treat them as ordinary source material and cite the relevant page when answering.

Help Desk priority and escalation

Use a ticket for routine work. Use the service desk phone line for a widespread outage, a lost device, or an active security concern. The fictional phone extension is 4100.

PRIORITY	EXAMPLE	FIRST RESPONSE TARGET
P1 - Critical	Company-wide sign-in outage or confirmed active security incident.	15 minutes, 24/7
P2 - High	A whole team cannot access a required work application.	1 business hour
P3 - Standard	One employee has a VPN error or requests approved software.	1 business day
P4 - Planned	Non-urgent access change or equipment question.	2 business days

Submitting a useful ticket

Choose the closest category, describe the expected and actual result, add the first time the issue occurred, and list the troubleshooting steps already tried. Include an asset tag if a managed device is involved. The ticket number is returned in the Help Desk and by company email. Duplicate tickets about the same event should reference the first ticket rather than restart the queue.

Escalation path

If a P1 issue has no response after 15 minutes, call extension 4100 and quote the ticket number. If a P2 issue has no response after one business hour, reply to the existing ticket requesting escalation. For P3 and P4, follow up in the same ticket after the stated first-response target. First-response targets are not promises that the issue will be resolved within that time.

Service hours

The desk handles P2 through P4 during Monday to Friday, 09:00-18:00 Korea Standard Time, excluding company holidays. P1 intake is available at all times. Requests received outside business hours enter the next business-hour queue unless classified P1.

UNKNOWN FACTS

This handbook does not list holiday dates, payroll policy, travel reimbursement, or hardware purchase prices. A document-grounded assistant should say those details are unavailable here rather than infer them.